



Aquatics Water lilies float on the surface but are rooted under water.



Marginals Many types of iris are ideal for pond-side positions.

MARGINALS AND WATER PLANTS

Plants that thrive in water fall into two main categories: marginals, which grow in shallow water, usually 3–6in (7–15cm) deep; and aquatic plants, which include water lilies, and generally grow at depths of between 12in (30cm) and 6ft (1.9m). Ideally, a natural pond will include a range of marginals and deep-water aquatics to create a balanced ecosystem, as well as a few “oxygenators.” These are submerged, fast-growing plants that release oxygen into the pond, and compete for nutrients with pond weeds and algae, helping to keep the water clear. Hornwort and water crowfoot are examples of noninvasive oxygenators.

SHRUBS

These woody-stemmed plants produce a permanent network of branches that rise up from the ground or a central trunk to create a bushy form. They can be deciduous or evergreen, and provide a structural framework in many gardens. Shrubs are diverse in size, shape, and habit, from subshrubs like wormwood and lavender that have a woody base and tender new growth to treelike mock orange. Many shrubs give a long season of interest, bearing flowers, decorative fruits, and attractive fall foliage. Other shrubs can be made into features by pruning and training, such as boxwood, which is used in topiary.



Flowering Roses are highly popular summer-flowering shrubs.



Foliage and form Evergreen shrubs give texture and interest.



Bulbs Snowdrops are among the first bulbs to flower each year.

BULBS

This group includes all plants that form bulblike structures, such as corms, tubers, rhizomes, and true bulbs. Popular bulbous plants include spring tulips and daffodils, which are planted in fall, and summer-flowering dahlias, lilies, and gladioli, which are planted in spring.



Trees Highly varied, there are trees to suit all parts of the garden.

TREES

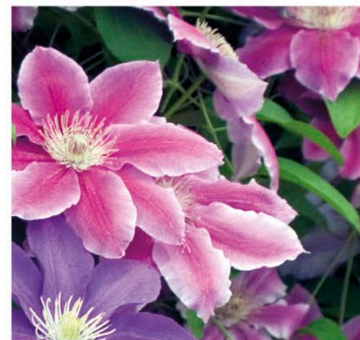
Providing the main architecture in the yard or garden, trees are also grown for their flowers, bark, and foliage. Whether deciduous or evergreen, they can form a spreading, rounded, conical, weeping, or columnar canopy of leafy branches from a central trunk, leading to trees of all shapes and sizes.

CLIMBERS

This group of woody-stemmed and perennial plants uses a variety of methods to climb over structures or through host plants. Twining climbers, such as clematis, use leaf stalks, tendrils, or stems to coil around a support, while the thorny stems of roses act as hooks to heave themselves up. Self-clinging climbers, including Virginia creeper and Boston ivy, attach themselves to supports with adhesive pads or aerial roots. Climbers can be evergreen or deciduous, fast or slow growing, and while perennial forms die back each year, many shrubby climbers develop a substantial and permanent structure.



Woody climbers These require a sturdy support to hold their stems.



Perennial climbers Dying back each year, these suit smaller plots.